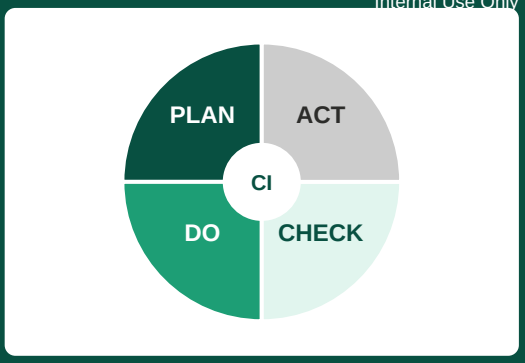
Internal Use Only

PDCA

A four-step scientific method — Plan, Do, Check, Act — for iterative problem solving and continuous improvement.



WHEN TO USE

For any problem where the root cause or solution is not yet known and needs to be tested empirically.

HOW TO APPLY — STEPS

1. Plan — define problem, root cause hypothesis, and experiment design
2. Do — run a small-scale, controlled test
3. Check — compare results against the hypothesis rigorously
4. Act — standardise if successful; return to Plan with new hypothesis if not

PRACTITIONER TIP

! The Check step is where most teams fail. Be ruthlessly objective — if data doesn't support the hypothesis, the hypothesis was wrong.

KEY OUTPUTS

- PDCA worksheet with hypothesis
- Test results data
- Updated process standard

HOW TO MEASURE SUCCESS

PDCA cycle time in days; % of cycles resulting in sustained, verified improvement

TOOL CATEGORY

Quality & Process